

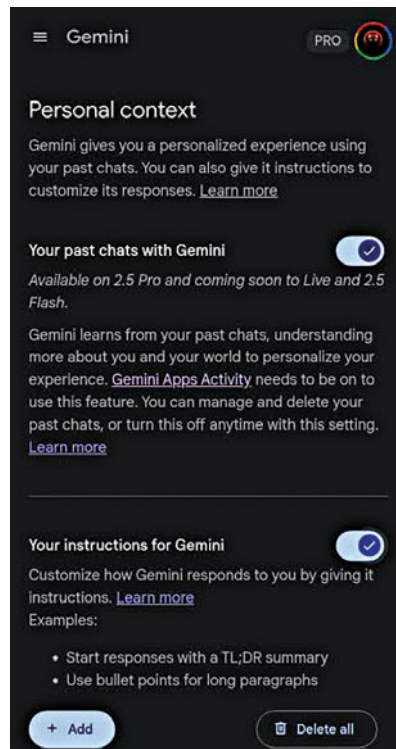
– delivered on a schedule you choose, even when the app is closed. Just describe the task and the cadence in a normal chat ("summarise any new AI tool announcements every morning at 8") and Gemini turns it into a scheduled action; it can tap connected apps like Gmail and Calendar.

This is great for the recurring research or prep you currently do by hand every morning becomes a standing feed. A student can wake up to a digest of campus deadlines and topic updates; a young professional gets a pre-standup brief assembled before they sit down. A few caveats worth knowing: it's a paid feature, you need "Keep Activity" turned on, and there's a cap of 10 active scheduled actions at a time – so prioritise the ones tied to a real decision rather than scheduling noise.

Deep Research over your own sources

Deep Research is an agent, not a quick chat reply: it breaks your question into sub-questions, searches across a large number of sources, and returns a cited, multi-page report in roughly 5–10 minutes. Crucially, you can point it at your own material – Gmail, Drive, uploaded files, NotebookLM notebooks – so a single run blends external web research with your internal docs.

Instead of opening twenty tabs and stitching together a literature review or market scan yourself, you get a structured, footnoted draft to work from. A student can have it synthesise course readings plus current scholarship into one referenced overview; a young professional can have it combine industry reports from the web with the company docs in their Drive. Because it cites sources, you can verify claims rather than trusting a black box – which matters when the output is going into graded or professional work. You can also set Deep Research as a Gem's default tool, so a research-focused Gem runs in that mode automatically.



Set personal context once

In Settings, fill in your role/job title or course, your field, your goals, and your preferred communication style. This is genuinely the highest-leverage tweak for output quality and the one most people skip.

Once Gemini knows you're, say, a second-year law student who wants

concise, exam-oriented answers – or a junior marketer who wants a confident, plain-English tone – every response is calibrated to that without you re-explaining it each time. Unlike a Gem (which only fires when opened), this context applies across all your chats, so it raises the baseline quality of everything. Five minutes here saves a lot of "actually, make it shorter / simpler / more formal" corrections later.

Anthropic Claude

Cowork is what Claude does better than others

Cowork is pitched as "Claude Code for the rest of your work" – an agentic desktop app (macOS and Windows) that takes a goal rather than a single prompt, reads and writes your local files directly, breaks complex jobs into steps (sometimes spinning up parallel sub-agents), and produces finished deliverables like formatted docs, working spreadsheets, or slide decks. With scheduled tasks, Claude can complete work for you automatically, which isn't possible in regular chats.

Just point Claude at a folder of lecture notes or source PDFs and ask for a structured draft, or have it sort and rename a messy Downloads folder, and step away while it works. The highest-leverage starting move is a single scheduled task – type /schedule in a Cowork task to set up, say, a 7 am brief of your calendar and unread email – before scaling to anything bigger. Two practical caveats: it's on paid plans (Pro and up), and scheduled tasks only run when your computer is on and the Claude Desktop app is open – if it's asleep, the task runs next time you open the app.

Dispatch from your phone

Dispatch lets you trigger Cowork agents remotely. From your phone, you can access everything on your desktop through Claude – files, connectors, installed plugins, and your apps – and Claude messages you the

GEMINI'S SUPERPOWER

Gemini can turn your own messy Drive into an interrogatable knowledge base.

Point it at a folder of your actual documents, lecture notes, or research PDFs and run Deep Research over your own files blended with the live web, getting back a cited, multi-page report that synthesizes what you already have with what's newly out there. Its deep Google Workspace integration makes this near-frictionless in a way the others can't match.